

BT Group Interview - Start Here & Battle Plan

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Built from the BT job description, your placement cell's question list, and your CV

Study pack - part 0 of 9

Contents

Read this page first. It takes four minutes.	3
The order to study in tonight	4
Your positioning for this interview	5
The register rule - important	5
The one rule about your projects	5
Self-introduction - technical rounds (1 and 2)	7
Self-introduction - HR round (3)	8
Three habits for the room	9
Say the name right	10
The night plan	11

Read this page first. It takes four minutes.

You have one night. This pack is written so you can study it in priority order and still be fine if you never reach the last document.

What this interview actually is. The job title says “Service Reliability Engineer”, but read the job description again - it is **first-line network service assurance**. You will be watching enterprise networks, picking up alarms and tickets from a queue, doing the first diagnosis, fixing what you can and escalating what you cannot. That is why the job description is 80% networking and 20% “can you talk to people calmly”.

The three rounds, from your placement cell:

Round	What they test
1	Networking - software <i>and</i> hardware - plus English vocabulary
2	Networking again, plus the projects on your CV
3	HR / general

Read that table twice. **Networking appears in two of the three rounds.** Not DSA. Not system design. Not React. Networking.

The order to study in tonight

Do them in this order. Do not jump ahead because something looks more interesting.

Priority	Document	Time
1	01 - Networking Core Q-Bank (all 80 questions your faculty sent)	3 hours
2	02 - Networking JD Deep Dive (the harder things in the JD - subnetting, STP, OSPF, BGP, HSRP, MPLS)	2 hours
3	03 - Projects: Simplified + Deep-Dive Defence	1.5 hours
4	04 - ChatterBox spec (your chat project - know it cold, it is on your CV)	1 hour
5	05 - BT Group research	30 min
6	06 - The role decoded	20 min
7	07 - HR answers, English vocabulary, final checklist	40 min
8	08 - Cloud & virtualisation (insurance - your faculty's list has it, and BT sells cloud connectivity)	30 min

If you run out of night, the order above is also the order of what matters. Documents 01 and 03 are the two you cannot skip.

Sleep. Two hours of sleep beats two more hours of revision at 6am. You cannot listen carefully to a question while your brain is fogged, and this role is explicitly scored on listening.

Your positioning for this interview

Last time the story was “I build and own big products”. **That is not the story here, and you have deliberately changed your CV to match.** The new story is:

A computer science student who builds web applications and, more importantly, has actually put them on Linux servers and kept them running - DNS, Nginx, HTTPS, ports, logs. I know the network from the software side, I know I have a lot to learn about the hardware side, and I learn quickly when someone teaches me.

Three things that story does for you:

1. **It is honest.** Every part of it is on your CV and you can defend all of it.
2. **It is humble.** You are not claiming to be a network engineer. You are claiming to be teachable, which is exactly what a first-line support team wants.
3. **It bridges.** Every deployment thing you have done - a reverse proxy, a DNS A record, a TLS certificate, a firewall port - is a real networking concept. You are not a stranger to their world; you have met it from the other side.

The register rule - important

You are not going to talk about “ownership” tonight or tomorrow. Not once. Your CV now says **Full Stack Developer Intern**, so any “I owned the product” language would contradict the paper in front of them and make you look inflated.

Use this vocabulary instead:

Don't say	Say
“I owned the whole product”	“I worked on it and I got to see the whole thing end to end”
“I architected a scalable system”	“I built it, and here is how it works”
“I led the development”	“I was the developer on it, and I asked a lot of questions”
“I'm an expert in X”	“I've used X a fair amount - here's what I understand about it”

The humility is not a performance. It is genuinely the right register for a first-line role in a very large company, and interviewers detect the difference instantly.

The one rule about your projects

Your projects are bigger and more complicated than what is now written on your CV. That is intentional. **Describe them at the size they are written.** Simple description, simple follow-up questions, complete confident answers.

But **never lie about a technical fact.** Simplified is fine. Wrong is fatal - especially in round 2, where they will dig. Document 03 gives you the exact wording for each project, plus the deeper layer to reveal

only if you are asked directly.

Self-introduction - technical rounds (1 and 2)

Around 45 seconds. Say it in your own words, not this one memorised.

“Good morning, I’m Nirmalya Mandal. I’m in my final year of Computer Science at Amity University Kolkata.

Most of what I’ve learned has come from building small web and mobile applications - and then, which I actually enjoy more, putting them on a Linux server and keeping them running. So I’ve set up Nginx as a reverse proxy, added DNS records for domains, installed HTTPS certificates, opened and closed ports, and spent plenty of evenings reading server logs trying to work out why a request was failing.

That’s the side of things that made me apply for this role. I’ve met networking from the software end, and I know there’s a whole hardware and infrastructure side I haven’t touched yet - routers, switches, WAN links - which is exactly what I’d like to learn properly.

On the technical side I mostly use JavaScript, TypeScript and Python, with PostgreSQL for databases. The project I’d most enjoy talking about is a small real-time chat application I built, because it’s the one where I actually had to think about how the connection between the browser and the server works.”

Why this works: it ends by *offering them* the project you most want them to ask about. Round 2 is “networking + projects from CV” - if they take the chat app, you are answering networking questions on ground you have prepared.

Self-introduction - HR round (3)

“I’m Nirmalya, a final-year CS student from Kolkata. The short version of me is that I like understanding how things actually work, and I don’t mind the unglamorous parts - the debugging, the setup, the bit where something is broken at 11pm and you have to calmly find out why.

I’ve done a development internship and some client project work, so I’ve had to explain technical problems to people who aren’t technical at all - business owners, mostly. That taught me to slow down and use plain language, which I think matters more than people expect.

I’m honestly still early in my career and there’s a lot I don’t know yet. What I’m looking for is a place where I’ll be taught properly and where the work is real. That’s why a first-line service role at BT appealed to me - it’s real systems, real customers, and structured enough that I’d learn the right habits from the start.”

Three habits for the room

1. **Listen to the whole question before answering.** The JD literally lists “be an active listener” as a required skill. If a question is long, it is fine to say “just so I understand - are you asking about X or about Y?” That scores points; it does not lose them.
2. **If you don’t know, say so, then reason out loud.** “I haven’t worked with that directly. Can I tell you what I do know that’s related, and what I’d guess?” That is a good answer. Bluffing is the only bad answer.
3. **Short answer first, then stop.** Two or three sentences, then let them ask. Do not empty the whole document into one answer.

Say the name right

It is **BT** or **BT Group** - two letters, “B-T”. In the UK it grew out of **British Telecom**, and people do say “British Telecom” casually, but the company is BT Group and has been since 2001. Say “BT Group” and you sound current.

The night plan

Time	Do
Now - 3 hrs	Document 01, all 80 questions. Read the answer, then close the file and say it out loud.
+2 hrs	Document 02. Subnetting worked examples on paper - actually write them.
+1.5 hrs	Document 03. Write out one API route with its payload on paper. Draw one schema from memory.
+1 hr	Document 04, ChatterBox. Know its schema and its WebSocket flow.
+1 hr	Documents 05, 06, 07.
Then	Sleep. Set two alarms.
07:30	Re-read document 01's quick-fire table and document 07's checklist. Nothing else.